Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
Held Electronically
At 1:00 p.m. on November 15, 2021

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Chair - Councillor	L. Bower
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		A. Khan
	Mayor	S. Collier

1. Call to Order

Chair Bower called the meeting to order at 1:01 p.m.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interests.

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1 Regular Meeting

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on October 12, 2021 be adopted.

CARRIED

3.2 Closed Session

Moved by: A. Khan

That the Minutes of the Closed Session of the General Government Committee held on October 12, 2021 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Consent Agenda

Members separated items 4.3, 4.6, 4.9, 4.10 and 4.11 for discussion.

Moved by: S. Lee

That items 4.1, 4.2, 4.4, 4.5, 4.7 and 4.8 of the consent agenda be adopted.

CARRIED

4.1 FIN-2021-16: Capital Account Closing Report, August 31, 2021

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That Council receive the attached listing of Capital Account Closings as of August 31, 2021 for information.

2. That funding transfers to/from the Reserves and Reserve Funds related to the August 31, 2021 Capital Account Closings, in accordance with the Financial Sustainability Plan, be approved as follows:

Reserve / Reserve Fund	Transfers to	Transfers from	Net Amounts
Capital Contingency Reserve	-	$78,098.86	$78,098.86
Building Maintenance Reserve	($591,530.78)	$79,101.82	($512,428.96)
General Infrastructure Reserve	($212,263.08)	-	($212,263.08)
Strategic Initiatives Reserve	($14,383.63)	-	($14,383.63)
Vehicle / Equip. Replacement Reserve	($133,773.40)	-	($133,773.40)
Total Transfers Approved on Closing	**($951,950.89)**	**$157,200.68**	**($794,750.21)**
Previously approved transfers	-	$9,999.73	$9,999.73
Total Approved Transfers	($951,950.89)	$167,200.41	($784,750.48)

CARRIED

4.2 AFES-2021-02: May 2021 Ajax Fire & Emergency Services Fire Master Plan (FMP) Three Year Implementation Plan

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That this report be received; and;

2. That the Fire Chief be directed to utilize this report to form the framework for the phased implementation of the 2021 Fire & Emergency Services Fire Master Plan as part of the annual budget process.

CARRIED

4.3 LIS-2021-19: 2022 Municipal Elections: Compliance Audit Committee Terms of Reference

Committee Members asked questions regarding the vetting process for applicants. Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Services/Clerk, responded to the question

from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the bylaw to establish a Compliance Audit Committee for the 2022 Municipal Election in Ajax, included as Attachment 1 to this report, be included on a future Council agenda for approval; and

2. That the Town Clerk be directed to participate in the recruitment of Compliance Audit Committee members through the Joint Compliance Audit Committee with other Durham lakeshore municipalities.

CARRIED

4.4 LIS-2021-17: Integration of Asset Management (Cityworks) - Project Over Budget

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That Council award the contract for the completion of the Cityworks Project (Integration of Asset Management), to GHD in the amount of $133,664.31 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That Council approve funding of $157,324.52 to be allocated to Capital Account No. 1016711 from the Canada Community Building Fund (CCBF) previously FGT.

CARRIED

4.5 LIS-2021-16: Request from Region of Durham for Ajax Council Resolution related to 311 Calls

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That the council of the Town of Ajax does not object to the routing of 311 dialed calls originating from the overlap that exists between the Town of Ajax and the geographical area of the Regional Municipality of Durham; and;

2. That the above approval is given on the understanding that where callers dial 311 and reach the Region of Durham but require service from the Town of Ajax, they will be given the option of being transferred to the main switchboard of the Town of Ajax.

CARRIED

4.6 LIS-2021-18: Updates to Public Notice Policy

Committee Members asked questions regarding printed notice requirements and criteria used to determine if public notice is required. Alexander Harras, Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

1. That the revised Public Notice Policy, included as Attachment 1 to this report, be approved; and

2. That the Town Clerk be delegated the authority to determine a date on which the revised Public Notice Policy shall come into effect.

CARRIED

4.7 OES-2021-02: Final Report on Over-Expenditure – Road Resurfacing – 2018

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That the report on the net over-expenditure of $27,399.60 (net of HST rebate) on the Road Resurfacing 2018 project, Capital Account No. 995511, previously awarded to Four Seasons Development Ltd. be received for information.

CARRIED

4.8 OES-2021-03: Final Report on Over-Expenditure – Mills Road Reconstruction

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That the report on the net over-expenditure of $133,677.11 (net of HST rebate) on the Road Resurfacing 2018 FGT project, Capital Account No. 996611, previously awarded to Mar-King Construction Company Ltd. be received for information.

2. That Council approve funding of $27,313.37 to be allocated to Capital Account No. 996611 from the Federal Gas Tax reserve fund.

CARRIED

4.9 PDS-2021-45: Surety Bonds – Alternative Development Security Option

Committee Members asked questions regarding the pilot project start date, opportunities to assign a specified dollar amount to the surety bond, surety bond eligibility requirements, potential negative consequences associated with surety bonds, mitigating risk to the municipality, drawdown frequency among other municipalities, and historical drawdowns by the Town on letters of credit. Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services and Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Council approve the use of surety bonds as an acceptable form of security for a 24 month pilot project starting January 1, 2022; and

2. That staff be directed to report back to the General Government Committee in January 2024 regarding the success and/or challenges related to enabling the development community to submit surety bonds as a form of development security.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That clause 1 be amended to read as follows:

1. That Council approve the use of surety bonds **to an upset limit of $1 million** as an acceptable form of security for a 24 month pilot project starting January 1, 2022;

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Council approve the use of surety bonds to an upset limit of $1 million as an acceptable form of security for a 24 month pilot project starting January 1, 2022;

2. That staff be directed to report back to the General Government Committee in January 2024 regarding the success and/or challenges related to enabling the development community to submit surety bonds as a form of development security.

CARRIED

4.10 **PDS-2021-46: Review of Underutilized Town Facilities**

Committee Members asked questions regarding annual operating costs, rationale for retaining underutilized town facilities, land values, opportunities for not-for-profit sector organizations to lease underutilized facilities, historical and current revenues, facility usage, restrictions for heritage designated properties, current zoning for properties, opportunities to generate revenue from property taxes, and timelines associated with property appraisals. G. Romanowski, Nadia Sukovski, Senior Economic Development Officer, Chris Vida, Acting Director of Recreation, Culture & Community Development, and D. Valentim responded to questions from Committee Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Council direct staff to develop a framework to identify, evaluate and select innovative start-up businesses to lease identified underutilized facilities to, as a foundational component of a future “Innovate Ajax” program; and

2. That staff report back to General Government Committee with details of this framework and the proposed “Innovate Ajax” program, in 2022.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That the motion be amended by adding the following clause:

3. That staff be directed to conduct appraisals on the Hartrick House and Sundial Sales Pavilion properties.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That Council direct staff to develop a framework to identify, evaluate and select innovative start-up businesses to lease identified underutilized facilities to, as a foundational component of a future “Innovate Ajax” program;

2. That staff report back to General Government Committee with details of this framework and the proposed “Innovate Ajax” program, in 2022; and

3. That staff be directed to conduct appraisals on the Hartrick House and Sundial Sales Pavilion properties.

CARRIED

4.11 PDS-2021-48: Contract Award – Pedestrian Crossing – Harwood & Haskell

Committee Members sought clarification regarding the status of the contract award and asked questions regarding construction timelines for the pedestrian crossing and widening of Harwood Avenue, and opportunities to reuse infrastructure encumbered by the road widening. John Grieve, Supervisor of Transportation, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: A. Khan

1. That Council award the contract for Pedestrian Crossing ~ Harwood & Haskell to Beacon Utility Contractors Limited in the amount of $94,148.82 (inclusive of all taxes)

2. That Council approve funding of $110,237.41 to be allocated to Capital Account No. 1018211 – Harwood Signal PXO from Capital Contingency Reserve.

CARRIED

5. Discussion

None

6. Presentations

6.1 PDS-2021-47: Automated Speed Enforcement (ASE) Implementation Plan

J. Grieve delivered a presentation reviewing the contents of the written report and recommendations contained therein. J. Grieve discussed project background, site selection process, community safety zones in Ajax, regulatory signage and equipment, proposed program schedule, process, agreements, financial implications, communication strategies, and next steps.

Committee Members asked questions regarding project delays, the projected ‘go-live’ date, opportunities to view speed data collected by the speed boards, radar speed board locations, rationale for ticket limitations, opportunities to set threshold speeds and camera operating hours, projected revenues, status of the request to have the Region implement the ASE program, doubling of fines in community safety zones, opportunities to expand the program outside community safety zones, community safety zone criteria, social media initiatives, impacts to the registered owner’s driving record, program costs, and

public consultation. J. Grieve and D. Valentim responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford

1. That Staff bring forward the amendments to the Speed Limit Schedules of the Town's Traffic By-law to the November Council Meeting; and

2. That the Automated Speed Enforcement (ASE) cameras for the Town of Ajax ASE program be activated on January 10, 2021 beginning with the first three locations and rotated as per the schedule outlined in the proposed deployment schedule in this report.

CARRIED

6.2 LIS-2021-15: Municipal Election Candidate Event Support Program

Sarah Moore, Committee & Accessibility Coordinator, delivered a presentation reviewing the contents of the written report and recommendations contained therein. S. Moore discussed program rationale, the Town's historical involvement with candidate events, program objective and overview, event framework, administration and accountability, and implementation timelines.

Committee Members asked questions regarding timelines for disbursement of funds, program costs, historical costs associated with 2018 candidate events, process for vetting program participants, and methods to mitigate risk factors. S. Moore and N. Cooper responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Municipal Election Candidate Event Program Policy (ATT-1) be approved.

CARRIED

7. Closed Session

None

8. Adjournment (3:02 p.m.)

Moved by: S. Collier

That the November 15, 2021 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

CARRIED